Conservation

UNIT 1

Preserving Buildings & Memories

WARM-UP SPEAKING

Discuss the questions below with a partner, or answer each one in about 30 seconds.

1. Is there an old building in your city that you think should be preserved? Why?

2. Do you keep any old photos, letters, or objects that mean a lot to you?

3. Do you think older things are usually better made than new things, or is that just nostalgia?

4. If you had to choose between restoring an old building and building something new in its place, which would you choose?

Article & Vocabulary

UNDERSTANDING KEY VOCABULARY

Article 1

1. The sentences below are about the value we place on old buildings. Choose the correct meaning (a, b or c) for the word in bold.

1 The critic said the museum's new galleries felt genuinely **vibrant**, full of colour, noise and energy.
a dull and quiet
b full of life and energy
c old-fashioned and outdated

2 Because the building was structurally unsafe, the council finally approved its **demolition**.
a the act of knocking a building down
b the act of repairing a building
c the act of selling a building

3 The old cinema is currently closed for **renovation** and should reopen next spring.
a the process of demolishing a building
b the process of repairing and improving a building
c the process of buying a building

4 Some of the damage caused by the fire turned out to be **irreversible**.
a able to be repaired completely
b impossible to change back to how it was before
c not very serious

5 Architects are increasingly **adaptive** in their approach, redesigning old factories for completely new uses rather than knocking them down.

a willing and able to change to suit new situations

b unwilling to make any changes

c focused only on brand-new buildings

6 Only a small number of **affluent** buyers could afford apartments in the restored waterfront building.

a having very little money

b having a lot of money

c interested in local history

7 From the outside, the warehouse looked like just another **anonymous** grey building, with nothing to suggest its history.

a famous and well-known

b beautiful and colourful

c without any distinctive or identifying features

8 After years of debate, the city finally **opted for** a compromise: restoring the facade while rebuilding the interior.

a rejected

b chose, after considering the alternatives

c forgot about completely

SHOULD WE ALWAYS SAVE THE PAST?

1 Walk through the centre of almost any old city and you'll find at least one building caught between two fates: careful restoration or the wrecking ball. Local councils across the world face the same dilemma every year — should a crumbling warehouse, theatre or factory be saved, or is **demolition** sometimes the more sensible choice?

2 Supporters of conservation argue that historic buildings give a city its character. A carefully planned **renovation** can turn a neglected structure into a genuinely **vibrant** public space — a market, a gallery, a community centre — rather than letting it sit empty and decaying. Increasingly, architects favour **adaptive** reuse: instead of restoring a building to look exactly as it once did, they redesign the interior for a completely new purpose while keeping the original facade. An old power station, for example, might become an art museum, its huge turbine hall left open rather than divided into small anonymous offices.

3 Critics, however, point out that conservation is expensive. A full structural renovation can cost far more than building something new, and this often means that only **affluent** developers, or well-funded public bodies, can afford to take on such projects at all. In cities with tight housing budgets, some argue that money spent preserving one old building might have built dozens of affordable new homes instead. There is also a harder truth: some structures have decayed so badly, or were built so cheaply in the first place, that the damage is effectively **irreversible**, and no renovation, however costly, could realistically save them.

4 In practice, most cities now **opt for** a case-by-case approach rather than a single fixed rule. A building of genuine historic or architectural value, even one that looks like an **anonymous** ruin to the untrained eye, might be protected by law and carefully restored, while a structurally unsound building with no real historic significance is cleared to make way for something new. This compromise rarely satisfies everyone: preservationists complain that too much is lost, while developers complain that protection laws slow down badly needed housing and infrastructure projects.

5 What almost everyone agrees on, though, is that the decision should never be made carelessly. Once a historic building has been demolished, the choice cannot be undone — and a city that tears down its past too quickly may find, decades later, that it has erased something it can never get back.

4 Match headings A–F to paragraphs 1–5 of Article 1. There is one extra heading you do not need.

A A costly and sometimes impossible task

B Giving old buildings a completely new purpose

C A tourist's-eye view of a historic district

D Weighing up each building individually

E A decision that cannot be reversed

F Two very different fates for old buildings

MATCH THE HEADING

LANGUAGE DEVELOPMENT — Compound adjectives

VOCABULARY SKILL

Compound adjectives

A compound adjective is made of two or more words joined together, often with a hyphen, to describe a noun as a single idea — for example a **state-of-the-art museum** or an **out-of-date software**. Once you recognise the pattern, you can understand many more of them.

energy-efficient	using less power to do the same job
fast-growing	increasing in size or number quickly
long-term	relating to a period of many years into the future
one-way	allowing movement or communication in only one direction
out-of-date	old-fashioned; no longer the newest or most useful
state-of-the-art	using the most modern and advanced methods or technology
well-known	known or recognised by many people

Complete the sentences with a compound adjective from the table above.

1. The museum's _____ climate-control system uses far less power than the air-conditioning it replaced.

2. Digital storage needs are _____, so archives must plan years ahead, not just for next year.

3. Many families still own a computer running _____ software that almost nothing can open anymore.

4. The new archive building has a _____ scanning lab that can digitise thousands of documents a day.

UNDERSTANDING KEY VOCABULARY

Article 2

The sentences below are about preserving digital records and memories. Match each word in bold to its definition (a–h).

1 Firefighters worked for hours to **retrieve** important documents from the damaged archive building.
2 Digital preservation is not a single event but an ongoing **practice** that takes regular maintenance.
3 Museums are particularly concerned about the **longevity** of digital photographs compared with printed ones.
4 Software updates are not always **compatible** with files created many years earlier.
5 Old recordings stored in obscure formats are especially **vulnerable** to becoming permanently unreadable.
6 Imagine a **scenario** in which a family's entire photo collection becomes impossible to open.
7 Growing concern about lost data has **prompted** several libraries to begin converting old files.
8 The museum's collection of **memorabilia** includes tickets, letters and photographs from decades past.

a (adj) able to work together or be used together without problems
b (n) a possible situation or sequence of events that could happen
c (v) to get something back, especially from a place that is difficult to reach
d (adj) easily harmed, damaged, or lost
e (n) the length of time something lasts or continues to exist
f (n) something done regularly as a habit or routine, often to maintain a skill or condition
g (v) to cause something to happen, or make someone decide to do something
h (n) objects collected because of their connection to a particular event, period or person

Complete the sentences with the correct form of a word from either article.

1 The empty factory was completely _____ last year to make space for a car park. (demolition)
2 Poor planning increased the building's _____ to serious structural damage. (vulnerable)
3 The architect's plan involved the full _____ of the old station into a new use as a market. (adaptive)
4 Experts questioned the long-term _____ of the software with newer computer systems. (compatible)
5 A wealthy family with unusual _____ funded the museum's expensive renovation. (affluent)

WHAT WILL SURVIVE THE FUTURE?

1 A hundred years ago, a family might have kept its history in a shoebox: photographs, letters, ticket stubs and other small pieces of **memorabilia** passed down from one generation to the next. Today, that same family's photos are more likely to exist as files on a phone, a laptop, or somewhere in the cloud. This shift raises an uncomfortable question: will any of it still be readable in a hundred years' time?

2 The problem is not that digital files disappear the way paper yellows and fades. It is that they become impossible to open. File formats go out of use, storage devices stop being made, and software updates are often not fully **compatible** with files created decades earlier. A photograph saved on a floppy disk in the 1990s may now be technically intact yet completely unreachable, simply because almost no device left in existence can read it. Digital archivists sometimes compare the situation to a library where the books survive perfectly, but every key that could unlock the building has been lost.

3 This has led museums, libraries and even ordinary families to think seriously about the **longevity** of their digital collections. Good digital preservation is not a one-off task but an ongoing **practice**: files must be periodically copied onto new devices and converted into current formats before the old ones become unreadable. Archivists describe certain kinds of data as particularly **vulnerable** — handwritten family recipes typed once into an obscure app, for instance, or voice recordings saved in a format no company still supports.

4 Consider one realistic **scenario**: a researcher fifty years from now wants to **retrieve** a relative's old messages and photos to write a family history, only to discover that the storage device still exists but nothing can open it. This exact worry has already **prompted** several national libraries to begin systematically converting historic digital files into up-to-date formats before they become permanently locked away, treating the problem with the same urgency once reserved for fragile paper manuscripts.

5 The irony is hard to miss: a handwritten letter from a century ago can still be read by anyone who picks it up, while a digital photo from twenty years ago may already need expert help to open. Preserving our digital past, it turns out, requires far more constant attention than anyone expected.

GRAMMAR FOR WRITING

GRAMMAR

First and Second Conditionals — accuracy for discussing conservation choices

We use conditional sentences to talk about the results of real or imagined choices — exactly what conservation debates are about: what happens if a building or record is saved, and what would happen if it weren't.

Conditionals link a condition (the if-clause) to a result. The tense you choose signals how real or likely the situation is.

1. First conditional — a real, likely future possibility: **if + present simple, will + infinitive.**

If the council doesn't act soon, the old theatre will fall into permanent disrepair.

2. First conditional can also use may / might / can instead of will, to sound less certain about the result.

If the city invests in the museum, visitor numbers might increase significantly.

3. Second conditional — an imagined or unlikely present/future situation: **if + past simple, would + infinitive.**

If the government banned all demolition, many unsafe buildings would simply collapse instead.

4. Second conditional is also useful for polite, hypothetical opinions in formal writing.

If I were responsible for the budget, I would prioritise buildings with genuine historic value

Exercise A — Read each situation. Which sentence, a or b, is the more appropriate response?

1 A city council is genuinely considering a real, current proposal to renovate a train station next year.

a If the council approves the plan, the station will reopen by next spring.

b If the council approved the plan, the station would reopen by next spring.

2 A student is imagining a completely unrealistic idea — knocking down every old building in the world.

a If every old building disappears, we will lose an enormous amount of history.

b If every old building disappeared, we would lose an enormous amount of history.

3 An architect is giving a genuinely possible warning about a real, decaying building this year.

a If nobody repairs the roof this year, the whole building will collapse.

b If nobody repaired the roof this year, the whole building would collapse.

Exercise B — Complete the paragraph with the correct form of the verbs in brackets: first or second conditional.

Our town has an old cinema that has been empty for ten years. If the council (1) _____ (not / find) new investment soon, the building (2) _____ (probably / face) demolition within a few years. Personally, if I (3) _____ (be) in charge of the budget, I (4) _____ (turn) it into a community arts centre instead of letting it disappear. Of course, if the town (5) _____ (choose) that option, it (6) _____ (need) significant funding for repairs. Still, if nothing (7) _____ (change) soon, we (8) _____ (lose) a building that has been part of this town for over a century.

ACADEMIC WRITING

Impersonal statements — sounding objective in formal writing

ACADEMIC WRITING SKILL

Impersonal statements

Academic and formal writing usually avoids '**I think**' or '**in my opinion**' and instead uses impersonal structures — passive forms, '**It is + adjective + that…**', or general nouns like '**many people**' or '**critics**' — to sound more objective and less personal.

AVOID: *I think old buildings are more important than new developments.*

WRITE LIKE THIS: *It is often argued that old buildings are more important than new developments.*

Rewrite the personal sentences below as impersonal, formal statements.

1 I believe cities spend too much money restoring old buildings.

_____

2 I think digital records are just as important as physical ones.

_____

3 In my opinion, governments should protect more historic sites.

_____

4 I feel that families should preserve old photographs more carefully.

_____

5 I don't think every old building deserves to be saved.

_____

WRITING TASK

Write a short paragraph (80–100 words) giving your view on whether digital or physical records are more important to preserve, using at least two impersonal structures from this section.

READING PRACTICE

PART 1

Read the text. Fill in each gap with ONE word. You must use a word which is somewhere in the rest of the text.

The online retail giant Amazon has released its first ever big-budget PC game. The game is called Crucible. It is a science-fiction shooter (1)_____. It has many unusual characters that have special powers. Crucible is currently only available in North America, where people can download it from the video distribution website Steam. Amazon said the game will be (2)_____ in other parts of the world soon. Crucible was created by Amazon Game Studios and Relentless Studios and is free. Amazon is a newcomer in the video games market. It hopes to become a major producer of games. Many experts on (3)_____ games believe Crucible could be very successful. They say it could be a rival to the game Fortnite. Crucible is set in an apocalyptic world on a fictional planet in outer space. Very few people can walk around outside on this (4)_____. Players can go outside but they must hunt and kill different creatures and monsters. They must also collect a special material called "essence". This helps (5)_____ level up and become stronger. Mike Frazzini, the vice president of Amazon Games, spoke about Crucible. He said he hoped it would help people to connect with each other. He told reporters: "We want to make games that resonate with a very large audience of players." He added: "One of the reasons I've always loved games is not only is it a fun form of entertainment, but it's a way to (6)_____ with others."

PART 2

Read the texts 7-14 and the statements A-J. Decide which text matches with the situation described in the statements. Each statement can be used ONCE only. There are TWO extra statements which you do not need to use. Mark your answers on the answer sheet.

A) This café is the first thing most travelers can go.

B) Workers can go there to kick back.

C) You can go there on any part of the day.

D) This café serves free chilling drinks.

E) You can a free sandwich, internet connection and herbal teas there.

F) Prices can go lowers on Saturday and Sunday there.

G) This café has both modern and vintage look combined.

H) You can visit this café right after you have shopped.

I) You can drink your tea and coffee and enjoy an internet connection free of charge.

J) This café has food that has no meat in it.

7. Breezy Bean Café

Located beside the industrial area. Enjoy a cozy corner to relax with fresh coffee and baked goods. Indoor seating only. We have a terrace but no tables. **Menu:** Espresso, cappuccinos, organic teas, croissants, and muffins. Free refills on brewed coffee.

8. Urban Grind Café

Located in the heart of the city, just across from the park. Enjoy artisan coffee and light bites in a modern space. We have communal tables and cozy booths. Menu: Cold brew, nitro coffee, fresh juices, bagels, and granola bowls

Free iced water.

9. The Rustic Cup

Located a bit distance away from our local market, our small café combines vintage charm with a selection of freshly brewed beverages. We have outdoor tables. Menu: French press coffee, herbal teas, flavored lattes, scones, and sandwiches. Free wi-fi.

10. Cozy Corner Café

Located near the biggest local Farm, Cozy Corner offers a warm atmosphere and farm-to-table snacks. COZY READING NOOK. INDOOR SEATING. Menu: Hot chocolate, freshly brewed coffee, vegan pastries, and salads. Free hot water refills.

11. Café On The Corner

Located beside the airport, Café On The Corner is perfect for a quick coffee break or a relaxing afternoon. SEATS BY THE WINDOW. QUAINT ATMOSPHERE. HOMEMADE COOKIES, ESPRESSOS, CAPPUCINOS, ICED LATTES, PASTRIES. FREE BREWED COFFEE.

13. The Daily Brew

Located beside the mall, we offer a laid-back vibe with a strong coffee selection. We have plenty of seats for individuals or groups. Menu: Espresso, cappuccinos, gourmet drinks (matcha lattes), cold brew, breakfast burritos, and pastries. Free water refills.

12. Sunrise Café

WE SERVE ALL DAY. RELAXED AMBIANCE AND LARGE WINDOWS. FRESH COFFEE AND SMOOTHIES. PANCAKES. PROTEIN SHAKES. +1 323 678 9012.

14. Bakers & Brews

We are known for its homemade pastries and strong coffee. We have plenty of space for groups. WE HAVE SPECIAL DISCOUNTS ON WEEKEND. Menu: Mocha, flat whites, croissants, quiches, and cakes. Free refills on brewed coffee. Free Wi-fi.

📌 Wordlist

1. refill
2. light bites
3. booth
4. charm
5. beverage
6. herbal tea
7. snack
8. vegan pastries
9. farm-to-table
10. quaint
11. laid-back
12. ambiance
13. protein shake
14. gourmet
15. reading nook

LISTENING PRACTICE

PART 1

You will hear some sentences. You will hear each sentence twice. Choose the correct reply to each sentence (A, B, or C).

1. A) I am proposed.

B) Quite well, actually.

C) Likewise.

2. A) The red one.

B) I want to know when.

C) I have chosen.

3. A) For a minute.

B) Tomorrow.

C) All day.

4. A) It must be expensive.

B) I haven't bought it.

C) Yeah, it is.

5. A) I will tell Mark.

B) It's a good mark, really.

C) Oh, Ok.

6. A) I'll pick up my dog.

B) We better go home.

C) I like cats, actually.

7. A) He must be busy.

B) He has a presume.

C) I'll arrive there ASAP.

8. A) We can build it too.

B) I heard it's the gym.

C) Our school is

PART 2

You will hear someone giving a talk. For each question, fill in the missing information in the numbered space.Write ONE WORD and / or A NUMBER for each answer.

REGISTAN SQUARE TOUR

The word "Registan" means "**sandy place**".

First Madrasa - built by a renowned **9**_____ and mathematician.

- facade has tileworks with geometric **10**_____.

Second Madrasa - is built in the 17th century.

- has an artwork of two lions hunting a **11**_____

- illustrates the ambitions of the **12**_____ at the time.

Third Madrasa - not only a madrasa but also a **13**_____.

The tour guide recommends to visit Registan in the **14**_____.

WRITING PART 1.1

USEFUL LANGUAGE — informal letter/note

Function	Useful phrases
Opening	*Hi [name], / Hey [name], / Guess what...! / You'll never believe this, but...*
Reacting / feelings	*I'm really disappointed/excited/worried about... / Honestly, I couldn't believe it when I heard... / I was gutted to hear that...*
Giving an opinion	*I think they should... / In my opinion, it'd be better if... / Personally, I reckon...*
Suggesting	*Maybe we could... / Why don't we...? / It might be worth (+-ing)...*
Closing	*Let me know what you think. / Talk soon, / Best, / Take care,*

PART 1.1 PRACTICE

You are a member of the City History Museum. You received this email from the museum director.

Dear Member,

I'm writing to let you know that the City History Museum will be closed for three months starting next week for essential renovation work. We want to make the galleries more modern and accessible. We'd love to hear your ideas for new exhibits or features before we reopen. Your feedback means a lot to us.

Best wishes,

The Museum Director

Task 1.1 — Write a note to your friend, who is also a museum member. Write about your feelings about the closure and what you hope the museum will be like when it reopens. Write about 50 words.

SAMPLE ANSWER

Hi Elyor, Did you hear the museum's closing for three months for renovations? I'm a bit sad — I love visiting on weekends! Still, I hope they'll add more interactive exhibits and better lighting in the old wing. Could be worth the wait. Let me know if you've heard more news!

PART 1.1 PRACTICE 2 — now you try

You are a resident of a town where an old cinema is going to be demolished. You received this notice from the town planning office.

Dear Resident,

We are writing to inform you that the old Regal Cinema on Mill Street, closed for the past five years, will be demolished next month to make way for a new car park. The site will help ease parking congestion in the town centre. We understand some residents have fond memories of the cinema and welcome your feedback before work begins.

Yours sincerely,
Town Planning Office

Task 1.1 — Write a note to your friend, who also grew up in the area. Write about your feelings about the news and what you think should happen to the building instead. Write about 50 words.

Now write your own answer below. No model this time — use the rules and phrases above to help you.

SPEAKING PART 1.2

QUESTIONS

1. Describe what you can see in these two pictures.
2. What are some of the benefits of preserving historical and cultural heritage?
3. Why might some people be less interested in visiting heritage sites and traditional places?

SAMPLE ANSWER

*1. **In the first picture,** I can see a modern, spacious city promenade lined with trees, where people are relaxing and walking along a waterfront path with massive, sleek glass skyscrapers towering in the background. I**n the second picture, in contrast**, there is a historic, cobbled street featuring traditional architecture, including an ornate stone gateway, a minaret, and a dome, with a few people strolling past small local shops.*

*2. **I think a major benefit of** preserving historical and cultural heritage is that it helps communities maintain a strong sense of identity and a tangible connection to their past. It also provides great educational value for future generations, while often boosting the local economy by attracting visitors to historic locations like the one shown in the second picture.*

*3. **On the other hand**, some people might be less interested in visiting heritage sites because they prefer the conveniences, shopping, and fast-paced entertainment found in modern cities, much like the area in the first picture. **Additionally,** some travelers might find historical locations a bit dry or disconnected from their contemporary interests, especially if the sites lack interactive or modern exhibits.*

USEFUL LANGUAGE

Starting your comparison

Both of these pictures show…

These two pictures show…

The two situations in these pictures are…

Talking about similarities

These two pictures/situations are similar because/in that…

In both pictures we can see…

One similarity between these two pictures/situations is that…

Another similarity might be that…

One thing that these two pictures/situations have in common is that…

One thing that these two pictures share is that…

The most obvious similarity is that…

These two pictures share the fact that…

Both pictures (…) in the same way.

Talking about differences

One of the most obvious differences (between these two pictures) is that…

Another difference is that…

Something that makes these two pictures different is…

What makes these two situations (so/completely) different is…

While the first picture …, the second one…

The first picture…. However, the second one…

The first picture… whereas the second one…

Although the first picture…., the second one…

On the one hand, the first picture shows… . On the other hand, the second one…





DESIGN

LOGOS & BRANDING

UNIT 2



WARM-UP SPEAKING

Discuss the questions below with a partner, or answer each one in about 30 seconds.

1. Can you think of a logo you'd recognise instantly? What makes it memorable?

2. Do you think a company's logo really matters, or is it just decoration?

3. Have you ever bought something — or avoided it — because of how it was designed or branded?

4. If you designed a logo for yourself, what would it look like?

Article & Vocabulary

UNDERSTANDING KEY VOCABULARY

Article 1

Read the sentences. Match each word in bold to its definition (a–h).

1 Before choosing a designer, the company drew up a clear list of **criteria** the new logo had to meet.
2 The bold red used in the original design **aroused** such strong reactions that the team softened the colour in later versions.
3 Good design should **convey** the right message about a brand within a couple of seconds.
4 A logo with rounded shapes and bright colours can feel **evocative** of childhood and playfulness.
5 Designers increasingly choose materials and processes that are **sustainable**, avoiding anything that harms the environment.
6 Even after a full rebrand, the company decided to **retain** its original mascot, since customers loved it.
7 The first version of the logo was simple; every **subsequent** update added a little more detail.
8 A strong logo can **reinforce** a company's reputation for reliability every single time a customer sees it.

a (adj) next; happening after something else
b (n) standards used for judging something
c (v) to keep; to continue having
d (v) to make someone have a particular feeling or reaction
e (v) to express an idea so that it is understood by other people
f (adj) making a person remember or feel a particular thing
g (adj) causing little or no damage to the environment and able to continue for a long time
h (v) to provide more support for an idea and make it seem true

Complete the sentences with the correct form of a word from either article.

1. Environmental _____ has become one more factor designers must consider today. (sustainable)
2. The brand's mascot has become closely _____ with reliability in customers' minds. (associate)
3. Years of small _____ turned a cluttered original design into something clean and modern. (refined)
4. A memorable logo can offer real _____ to a company's reputation over time. (reinforce)
5. What one design _____ should a new logo satisfy above all others? (criteria)

WHAT MAKES A LOGO WORK?

1 A good logo does an enormous amount of work in a very small space. In roughly the time it takes to glance at a phone screen, it needs to **convey** who a company is, what it stands for, and why it deserves attention — through little more than a shape, a colour, and sometimes a few letters. Ask ten designers what **criteria** a logo must meet, and you'll likely get ten slightly different lists, but a few themes come up again and again.

2 Simplicity is usually near the top. Studies that show people hundreds of unfamiliar logos consistently find that the ones remembered later share simple, uncluttered designs. A cluttered logo may look impressive up close, but shrink it down to a phone icon and the detail disappears entirely.

3 A logo also needs to be distinctive enough that people don't confuse it with a competitor's, while still being **evocative** of the right feeling. A children's toy brand might choose a colourful, playful design specifically because it's meant to feel fun and nostalgic, while a bank's logo is far more likely to look serious and dependable — a mismatch between feeling and industry can quietly undermine trust before a customer reads a single word.

4 Logos also need to survive change. A brand's first design is rarely its last: as tastes shift and technology changes, most **subsequent** versions simplify rather than complicate the original. A well-known athletic brand's swoosh, for example, has barely changed in decades, even as everything around it has been transformed. **Retaining** a recognisable core while updating small details lets a brand feel current without losing the customers who grew up trusting it.

5 Increasingly, companies also think about how a logo behaves across dozens of surfaces: a shopping bag, a tiny app icon, an animated loading screen. A mark that only works printed large on a shop window is no longer enough; it has to flex to a hundred different formats without losing its identity, which is one reason so many well-known logos have been quietly simplified over the past decade.

6 None of this happens by accident. A logo that succeeds tends to **reinforce** a brand's message every single time someone sees it, gradually building trust through pure repetition. An increasing number of companies also factor in **sustainable** design choices — from the materials a logo is printed on to the energy used by an animated version online — treating environmental impact as one more design criteria, not an afterthought.

7 What has **aroused** the strongest reactions in recent years, though, hasn't been simplicity or sustainability, but change itself: even a small redesign can provoke surprisingly passionate backlash from loyal customers who feel, for a moment, that something familiar has quietly been taken away.

Match headings A–H to paragraphs 1–7 of Article 1. There is one extra heading you do not need.

A Doing a lot in a small space

B Why simple designs stick in memory

C The environmental cost of printing

D Matching the feeling to the industry

E Built to last without losing the core

F One mark, a hundred formats

G Building trust through repetition

H When even a small change causes a big reaction

MATCH THE HEADING

LANGUAGE DEVELOPMENT - Describing emotional responses

VOCABULARY SKILL

Verb + noun collocations

Certain verbs regularly combine with the same small set of nouns to describe emotional reactions — for example **evoke memories**, or **stir up controversy**. Learning these as whole chunks, rather than word by word, makes your language sound far more natural.

evoke	feelings, memories, emotions (mixed)
inspire	confidence, awe, admiration (positive)
arouse	interest, curiosity, suspicion (mixed)
stir up	controversy, anger, opposition (negative)
generate	excitement, interest, enthusiasm (positive)
provoke	outrage, criticism, debate (negative)

Complete the sentences with the correct collocation from the table above.

1. The unusual new logo _____ a lot of criticism online within hours of its release.

2. A well-designed workspace can _____ real creativity in a team.

3. The bright colours of the packaging _____ curiosity even in people who weren't looking to buy anything.

4. Nostalgic design choices often _____ strong childhood memories in older customers.

UNDERSTANDING KEY VOCABULARY

Article 2

2 The sentences below are about rebranding. Choose the correct meaning (a, b or c) for the word in bold.

1. The new packaging design faced strong **opposition to** its bright colour scheme from long-time customers.

a support for

b disagreement with

c confusion about

2. Fans immediately noticed that the redesigned logo **resembles** the company's very first version from decades ago.

a looks like

b is completely different from

c is an improvement on

3. Choosing a new logo colour is a **strategic** decision that can take marketing teams months to finalise.

a unplanned and rushed

b related only to cost

c carefully planned to achieve a goal

4. She is considered the **foremost** expert on colour psychology in advertising today.

a most experienced and well-known

b most controversial

c least experienced

5. After customer feedback, the designers **refined** the icon, making small improvements rather than starting over.

a completely replaced

b improved with small changes

c made more complicated

6. Many shoppers **associate** the colour green with eco-friendly products, even before reading the label.

a confuse

b mentally connect

c avoid

7. A **distinctive** logo helps a brand stand out immediately, even in a crowded market.

a easily forgettable

b easy to recognise and different from others

c expensive to produce

WHY DO BRANDS REBRAND?

1. Every few years, a familiar logo quietly disappears and a new one takes its place — sometimes to almost no reaction, and sometimes to a wave of public **opposition to** the change so loud it makes international news. Rebranding, changing a company's visual identity and sometimes its whole message, is rarely a casual decision; it's usually the result of a strategic process that can take marketing teams months, or even years, to complete.

2. Companies rebrand for different reasons. Some have simply grown up: a business that started decades ago with a busy, detailed logo often finds that a **refined**, simplified version fits a modern, mobile-first world far better than the original ever could. Others rebrand because their reputation, fairly or not, has become tangled up with something they'd rather leave behind — a fast-food chain distancing itself from concerns about its food, for instance, may quietly remove language that customers **associate** with those old worries.

3. Timing matters enormously. Some companies wait until a logo starts to look dated, no longer feeling current to a younger audience raised on newer visual trends. Others act because of a shift in what they actually do: a photocopier company that now sells a much wider range of office technology may rebrand specifically to stop customers assuming it still only makes one product.

4. New platforms create pressure too. As more of daily life moves onto small screens, logos that once worked beautifully printed large on a building or a truck can struggle to survive shrunk down to a tiny, blurry app icon. Several major tech companies have simplified their logos for exactly this reason, dropping fine detail that simply disappears at a small size.

5. Rebranding is not without real risk, however. When one soft-drink company briefly replaced its familiar packaging with a plainer, more generic design, sales dropped noticeably within weeks — shoppers, it turned out, were specifically looking for a design that **resembles** what they already knew, and the company quietly brought the original back. Elsewhere, a **foremost** example of a successful large-scale redesign is a search engine's colourful logo, which now subtly transforms itself for different products while keeping the same core shapes and colours recognisable throughout.

6. What almost every successful rebrand shares, though, is restraint: keeping just enough of the original that loyal customers still associate the new version with the brand they already trust, while making it feel fresh enough for a new generation. A logo that changes too much, too fast, risks losing the very **distinctive** identity that made it valuable in the first place — proof that in design, as in most things, sometimes less really is more.

DISCUSSION

Work with a partner. Discuss the questions.

1 Think of a logo you dislike. What would you change about it, and why?

2 Do you think companies rebrand too often, or not often enough? Why?

GRAMMAR FOR WRITING

GRAMMAR

Defining relative clauses, omission & reduced clauses

Defining relative clauses add essential information that identifies exactly which person, thing, or place we mean — without them, the sentence would be unclear or incomplete. Unlike non-defining clauses, they use no commas, and the relative pronoun can sometimes be left out or reduced to a participle.

The rules below explain when a relative pronoun (who / which / that / where) is needed, when it can be dropped, and when the whole clause can be reduced to a participle phrase.

1. Use **who/that for people, and which/that for things,** to identify exactly which one you mean — no commas.

The designer who created the logo later became famous for minimalist branding

2. Use **whose** to show possession inside a defining clause.

A company whose logo changes too often can confuse loyal customers.

3. Use **where** for a place, in the sense of '**in/at which**' — it cannot be omitted.

This is the workshop where our designers create new prototypes.

4. The relative pronoun CAN be omitted when it is the OBJECT of the clause (not the subject).

The logo (that) the team designed last year is still in use today.

5. *The relative pronoun* ***CANNOT be omitted*** *when it is the SUBJECT of the clause.*

The designer who redesigned the logo now works for a different company.

6. *A clause with* ***which/that + verb*** *can often be reduced to a participle phrase: drop the pronoun and change the verb to* ***-ing.***

There are delays for people who travel to work on Southern Region trains. → There are delays for people travelling to work on Southern Region trains.

Exercise A — Complete the paragraph with a relative pronoun where it is needed. Leave the space blank if the pronoun can be omitted.

The designer (1) _____ created our new logo studied graphic design in Milan. She used a colour palette (2) _____ she chose after months of research. The client (3) _____ she worked with wanted something modern but timeless. The first sketch (4) _____ she showed us in April was completely different from the final version. A logo (5) _____ works well in black and white usually works everywhere. The agency (6) _____ we hired last year has redesigned dozens of well-known brands. The feedback (7) _____ the team received from focus groups shaped almost every decision. The version (8) _____ finally launched in June kept the original colours but simplified the shape.

Exercise D — Combine each pair of sentences into one, using where or a reduced participle clause as shown in the rules above.

1. The design studio is in the old power station. Our designers create new prototypes there. (where)
2. The rebrand leads to instant recognition. It cost the company millions. (participle)
3. This is the exhibition hall. Visitors can see the winning designs there. (where)
4. The new logo appeals to a younger audience. It has boosted sales significantly. (participle)

ACADEMIC WRITING

Paraphrasing — expressing other people's ideas in your own words

ACADEMIC WRITING SKILL

Paraphrasing

Paraphrasing means expressing someone else's idea in your own words, using different vocabulary and sentence structures, without changing the original meaning. It's essential when summarising a source, and if you keep any of the original wording, it must go in quotation marks.

ORIGINAL: *A good logo must also be unique so it will not be confused with the logo from another organisation.*

PARAPHRASE: *For a logo to work well, it needs a distinctive design so people don't mix it up with a rival's.*

Paraphrase the sentences below in your own words, without copying the original phrasing.

1 Logos should be flexible enough to adapt across time and placement.

_____

2 The public generally resists changes to familiar logos at first.

_____

3 More than anything else, a logo needs to tell a story.

_____

4 Some companies simply need a new logo to show that they have matured as a business.

_____

5 A distinctive logo helps a brand stand out immediately, even in a crowded market.

_____

WRITING TASK

Write a short paragraph (80–100 words) paraphrasing an opinion you've read or heard about branding or design — from an article, a friend, or this unit — without copying the original wording directly.

READING PRACTICE

PART 3

Read the text and choose the correct heading for each paragraph from the list of headings below. There are more headings than paragraphs, so you will not use all of them. You cannot use any heading more than once.

List of Headings:

A) Legacy of Sassanids.

B) Once nomadic, then an empire.

C) The fall of the Empire.

D) Commercial influence.

E) Melting pot of nations.

F) Four major beliefs.

G) The distributor of faith.

H) In the middle of great civilizations.

15. Paragraph I

16. Paragraph II

17. Paragraph III

18. Paragraph IV

19. Paragraph V

20. Paragraph VI

KUSHAN EMPIRE

I. The Kushan Empire was a significant cultural and political entity that flourished in Central Asia and Northern India between the 1st and 3rd centuries CE. Its origins trace back to the Yuezhi, a nomadic group from the steppes of Central Asia. They established control over Bactria, a Hellenistic region, blending Greek, Persian, and Indian influences. The Kushans were instrumental in fostering trade along the Silk Road, connecting the East and West. Under their rule, arts, religion, and commerce flourished, making them a vital link in the ancient world's cultural and economic exchanges.

II. The Kushan Empire spanned a vast territory, including present-day Afghanistan, Pakistan, Northern India, and parts of Central Asia. It was strategically located along major trade routes, particularly the Silk Road. The empire's geographic position allowed it to act as a bridge between the Mediterranean, China, and Indian spheres of influences. This connectivity facilitated not only trade but also the exchange of ideas, technologies, and cultural practices. The Kushans expanded their influence through military conquests and diplomacy, securing their position as a dominant power in the region for over two centuries.

III. The Kushan Empire was pivotal in the flourishing of the Silk Road, a network of trade routes connecting Asia to Europe. The empire served as a hub for the exchange of goods such as silk, spices, gemstones, and textiles. Kushan coins, widely circulated, reflect their role in trade and economic integration. The Kushans also promoted caravanserais and security along trade routes, ensuring safe passage for merchants. This vibrant trade network enriched the empire economically and culturally, fostering interactions between diverse civilizations.

IV. Kushan art is a testament to the empire's diverse cultural influences, blending Greek, Indian, Persian, and Central Asian styles. The Gandhara School of Art, which thrived during their reign, is renowned for its Greco-Buddhist sculptures, particularly depictions of the Buddha. The Kushans were patrons of various art forms, including architecture, sculpture, and coinage. These artistic expressions not only reflected their cosmopolitan society but also played a significant role in spreading Buddhist iconography and religious ideas across Asia.

V. The Kushan Empire was a melting pot of religions, including Buddhism, Hinduism, Zoroastrianism, and Greek polytheism. They were instrumental in the spread of Buddhism to Central Asia and China. Emperor Kanishka, a notable Kushan ruler, convened the Fourth Buddhist Council, which contributed to the development of Mahayana Buddhism. The empire's tolerance and support for multiple faiths fostered a rich spiritual environment, influencing religious practices far beyond its borders.

VI. The decline of the Kushan Empire began in the 3rd century CE due to internal conflicts and external invasions, particularly by the Sassanid Empire and the Gupta Empire. Despite its fall, the Kushan Empire left a lasting legacy. It played a critical role in the cultural and economic integration of the ancient world. The empire's contributions to art, religion, and trade continue to be studied and celebrated, highlighting its importance in the history of Central and South Asia.

📌 Wordlist

1. entity ▢
2. flourish ▢
3. trace back to ▢
4. steppe ▢
5. nomadic ▢
6. blend ▢
7. establish control ▢
8. foster trade ▢
9. commerce ▢
10. vital link ▢
11. span ▢
12. trade route ▢
13. act a bridge ▢
14. spheres of influence ▢
15. facilitate ▢
16. military conquest ▢
17. dominant power ▢
18. pivotal ▢
19. serve as a hub ▢
20. reflect ▢
21. diverse ▢
22. patron ▢
23. spread ▢
24. be renowned for ▢
25. faith ▢
26. far beyond ▢
27. spiritual ▢
28. religious practice ▢
29. internal conflict ▢
30. legacy ▢

LISTENING PODCAST

TASK 1

📺 **Listen to the podcast and answer the questions.**

1. Liam says that Parkour is …

a. a type of military training.

b. a means of jumping off high buildings.

c. a way of overcoming obstacles.

d. a kind of video.

2. Liam's main job is …

a. to check the bikes are safe.

b. to clean the ramps.

c. to do demonstrations.

d. to teach young people about BMX.

3. Which area did Liam not have training in?

a. giving medical attention.

b. cooking hamburgers.

c. food hygiene.

d. basic accounting.

4.Why did Debbie volunteer the second time?

a. to be more competitive in the job market.

b. to help other people.

c. to complete her degree course.

d. to learn how to train volunteers.

5. Which sport did Debbie not volunteer to help with?

a. cricket

b. swimming

c. table tennis

d. football

6. Debbie and Liam both say that …

a. it's important to pay people to work in sport.

b. volunteers are often exploited.

c. they love volunteering.

d. volunteers are essential for sport.

TASK 2

Match the two parts of the phrase and write a–h next to the numbers 1–8.

1…….. to do	a. an experience
2…….. to overcome	b. a job
3…….. to volunteer	c. safety standards
4…….. to meet	d. to help
5…….. to organise	e. experience
6…….. to gain	f. an event
7…….. to deal with	g. the public
8…….. to share	h. an obstacle

TASK 3

📑 **Listen again and write a summary.**

- the main topic

- the key points

- important examples or facts

Write a 100–150 word summary in your own words.

LISTENING PRACTICE

PART 3

You will hear people speaking in different situations. Match each speaker (15-18) to the description they give about another person(A-F). There are TWO EXTRA options

Speaker 1 ...

Speaker 2 ...

Speaker 3 ...

Speaker 4 ...

A) to strengthen a relationship
B) to get some personal space
C) to help deal with extensive responsibilities
D) to meet the demands of colleagues
E) to cope with unpredictability
F) to avoid unfair criticism

Phrases & Idioms Wordlist

Stretched to the limit: Pushed as far as possible; almost exhausted (regarding patience or resources).

Squirrel (oneself) away: To hide or isolate oneself in a quiet, secluded place.

Fresh-faced: Looking healthy, youthful, and full of energy.

Stunned silence: Complete quiet caused by surprise or shock.

Make a drastic decision: To make a severe, extreme, or radical choice.

Can't get enough of (something): To enjoy something so much that you want more and more of it.

Let's face it: Let us be realistic and accept the truth of a situation.

Get on someone's nerves: To annoy or irritate someone a lot.

Make one's blood boil: To cause someone to become very angry.

Self-imposed: A rule, task, or restriction that you decide to put on yourself, rather than having someone else force it on you.

Not have a clue: To be completely ignorant or unaware of something.

Live on air: Broadcasting in real-time without pre-recording.

Tear one's hair out: To show extreme frustration, stress, or anxiety.

Throw (something) into complete disarray: To cause total confusion, disorder, or chaos.

Bear in mind: To remember or consider a specific piece of information.

Get worked up: To become upset, stressed, or overly emotional about something.

TECHNOLOGY

UNIT 3

TECHNOLOGY & DIGITAL LIFE



WARM-UP SPEAKING

Discuss the questions below with a partner, or answer each one in about 30 seconds.

1. How much time do you spend on your phone every day?
2. What's one piece of technology you couldn't live without?
3. Do you think people rely on technology too much nowadays?
4. Tell me about an app or gadget you started using recently.